

Sky Disaster Averted! Air India Dreamliner Saved From Catastrophic Crash by Faulty Fuel Switch!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

An Air India Boeing 787 Dreamliner was grounded after its left fuel control switch failed to stay in the 'run' position twice and moved to 'cutoff' during engine startup, the airline said. The flight number was AI 132.

Detailed analysis:

Aviation safety incidents involving national carriers attract wide public and regulatory attention, making this story vital for UPSC aspirants studying transport policy and disaster management.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/air-india-dreamliner-grounded-after-fuel-switch-moves-from-run-to-cutoff-10932403#publisher=newsstand>

Bombshell Budget Showdown! Rahul Gandhi vs Rajnath Singh Ignite Parliamentary Fireworks!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Budget Session of Parliament 2026 Highlights: Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi spoke during discussion on Motion of Thanks on the President's Address, a day after finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman presented her ninth Union Budget.

Detailed analysis:

Budget sessions are core to fiscal policy and governance, topics frequently tested in civil services exams; the clash between opposition and government leaders underscores parliamentary dynamics.

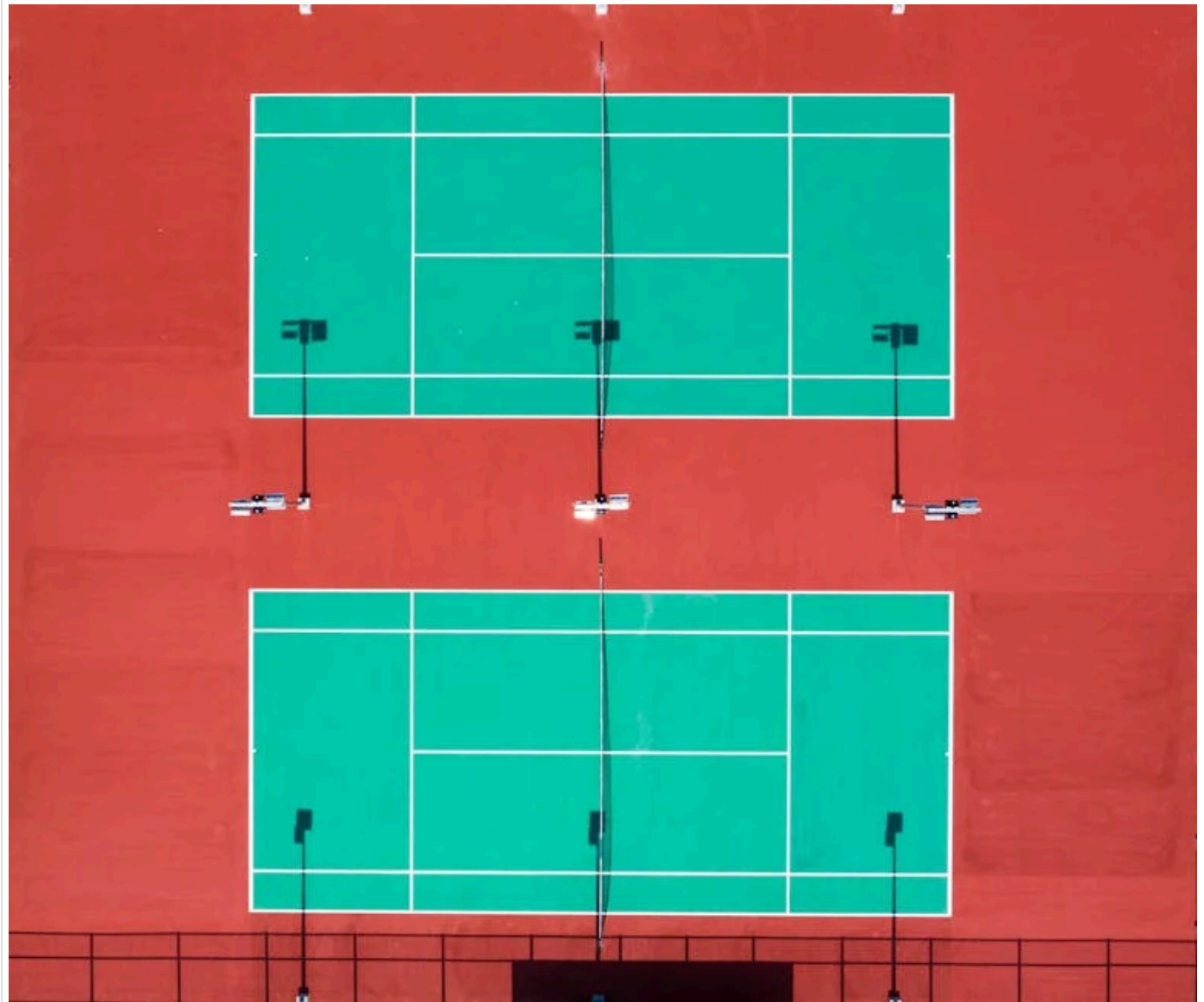
Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/parliament-budget-session-2026-live-lok-sabha-opens-today-with-debate-on-droupadi-murmus-address-18-hour-discussion-pm-modi-nirmala-sitharaman-10929064#publisher=newsstand>

Supreme Court Shocks Punjab! AAP Faces Crushing Blow as Bikram Majithia Gets Bail!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Supreme Court granting bail to Shiromani Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia in the disproportionate assets case marks a clear political setback for the ruling Aam Aadmi Party in Punjab.

Detailed analysis:

Judicial decisions affecting political leaders illustrate the intersection of law and politics, a key area for UPSC General Studies Paper II and ethics papers.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/supreme-court-bail-for-shiromani-akali-dal-bikram-singh-majithia-a-setback-for-aap-10931919#publisher=newsstand>

Mamata's Fiery Clash! Bengal CM Slams Election Chief as 'Liar' and Stages Dramatic Table-Banging!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has brought the SIR battle to the national capital. After meeting Election Commission officials, she threatened to bring lakhs of people to Delhi to parade before the Election Commission.

Detailed analysis:

State-central political confrontations are crucial for understanding federal relations and electoral integrity, topics frequently examined in the UPSC polity syllabus.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/can-get-lakhs-of-people-to-delhi-mamata-banerjee-targets-poll-body-over-sir-10932011#publisher=newsstand>

Global Tension Alert! Iran's President Pushes Nuclear Talks While Trump Promises Miracle Deal!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian has ordered the start of nuclear talks with the United States, local media said, after US leader Donald Trump said he was hopeful of a deal to avert military action against the Islamic Republic.

Detailed analysis:

India's foreign policy and global nuclear non-proliferation dynamics are part of International Relations, a vital segment of the UPSC syllabus.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/world-news/iran-president-orders-nuclear-talks-with-us-as-trump-hopeful-of-deal-10932670#publisher=newsstand>

Andhra Turmoil! Opposition Leaders Attacked After Heated Words on Chief Minister!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Political tension has escalated in Andhra Pradesh as supporters of the ruling Telugu Desam Party allegedly attacked the residences of senior YSR Congress Party leaders over the weekend.

Detailed analysis:

Regional political unrest highlights law-and-order challenges and party dynamics, important for the polity and governance sections of the civil services exam.

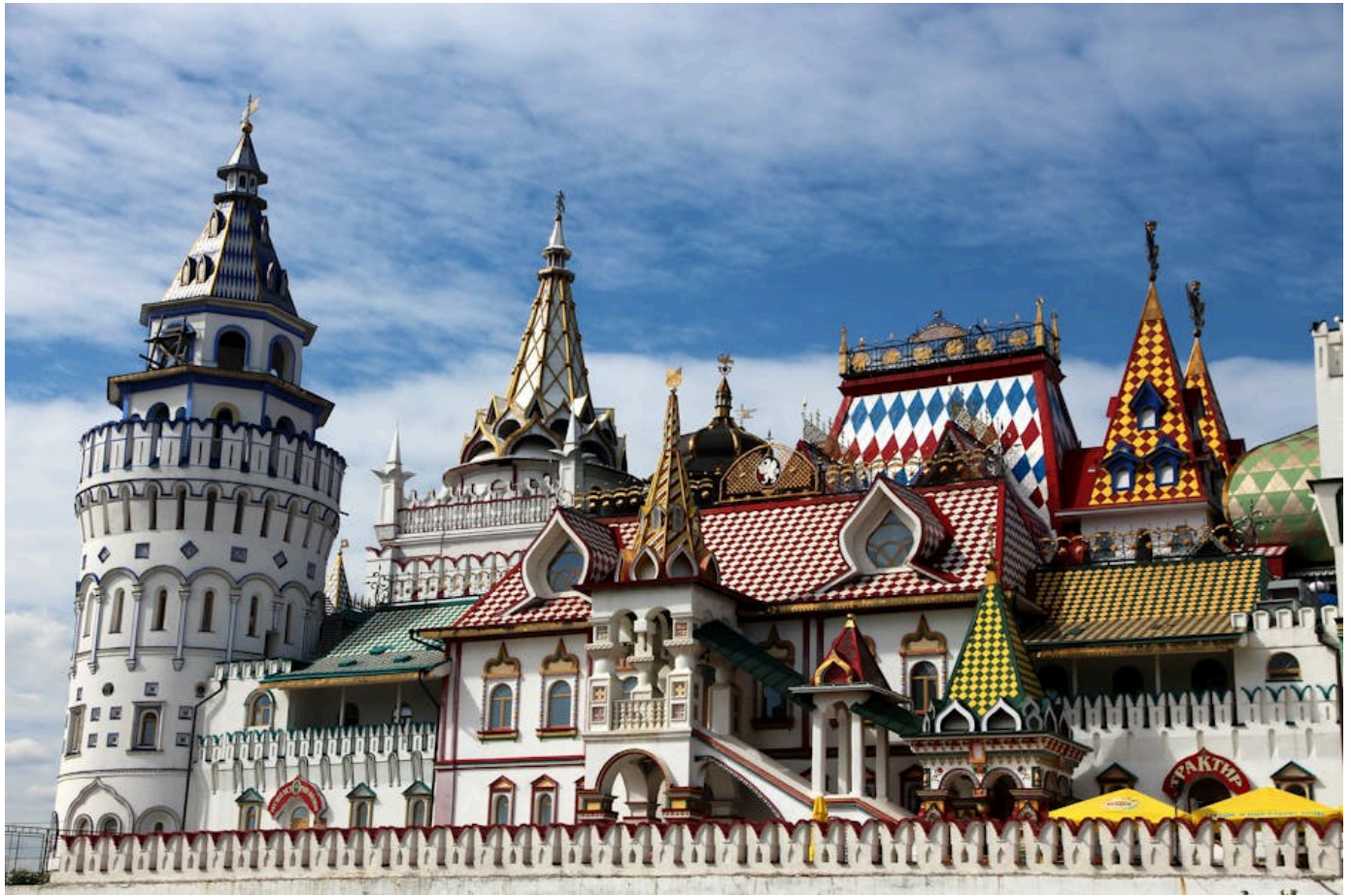
Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/unrest-in-andhra-over-remarks-on-c-naidu-2-opposition-leaders-targetted-10931521#publisher=newsstand>

Kremlin Says Russia is Secretly Cooling the Iran-US Heat!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Asked if Russia was discussing with Iran and the United States the possibility of taking Iranian enriched uranium, Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said: "This topic has been on the agenda for a long time"

Detailed analysis:

The statement signals Moscow's attempt to position itself as a mediator in a volatile Iran-US standoff, which could affect regional security calculations for India and other South Asian states.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/russia-is-trying-to-de-escalate-iran-tensions-kremlin-says/article70582832.ece>

India's 2026 Budget Unleashes Mega Reforms to Supercharge Tech & Defence!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

“The support in the Budget for semiconductors, electronics manufacturing, healthcare, agriculture, and logistics will help fuel next-generation growth,” the President and CEO of USISPF said

Detailed analysis:

The budget's emphasis on semiconductors, electronics and strategic sectors underscores the government's drive for self-reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat), a key topic for UPSC and other competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/union-budget-2026-technology-driven-reforms-sectors-boost-investment-usispf/article70582555.ece>

Gaza's Lifeline Reopens: Rafah Gate Cracks Open After Two-Year Siege!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Israel said the crossing had opened in a test, and the Israeli military agency that controls aid to Gaza said residents could begin crossing Monday. But only a small number of people can cross at first

Detailed analysis:

The tentative reopening hints at a possible humanitarian de-escalation and will be closely watched in international diplomatic forums, affecting India's stance on the Middle East conflict.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/israel-gaza-rafah-crossing-opening-february-2-2026/article70581484.ece>

China Sentences Ex-Justice Minister to Life, Deepening Xi's Anti-Corruption Crusade!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The sentence comes as President Xi Jinping presses ahead with a sweeping anti-corruption campaign that has ensnared a string of high-ranking officials in recent weeks

Detailed analysis:

The verdict illustrates the intensity of Xi's anti-corruption drive, a factor shaping China's internal politics and its foreign policy posture toward India and the region.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/china-hands-life-sentence-to-former-justice-minister-over-bribery/article70582771.ece>

Pakistan Launches Massive Sweep, Slays 177 Baloch Militants in 48-Hour Blitz!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Pakistani security forces have killed about two dozen militants in overnight raids in the insurgency-hit southwest bordering Afghanistan

Detailed analysis:

The surge in Baloch militant casualties signals heightened security operations near Pakistan's western frontier, a development relevant to India's strategic considerations along the shared border.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/pakistani-forces-kill-baloch-militants-in-48-hours-the-highest-toll-in-decades/article70582850.ece>

US Leaders Rally Behind India-US Alliance, Touting Global Peace Blueprint!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Consulate General of India in New York hosted a special reception in New York on January 31 to commemorate the 77th Republic Day of India

Detailed analysis:

The bipartisan endorsement underscores the strategic depth of the India-US partnership, a cornerstone topic for Indian foreign-policy studies and exam syllabi.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/bipartisan-interest-in-making-sure-india-us-relationship-is-strong-ties-vital-for-global-peace-top-american-leaders/article70581943.ece>

US Govt Halts Almost Everything as Shutdown Enters Day 3 – Chaos Hits Federal Agencies!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The US government stumbled into a partial shutdown Saturday while waiting for the House to approve a funding deal Trump worked out with Democrats following a national uproar over Border Patrol agents' killing of a US citizen in Minneapolis.

Detailed analysis:

A shutdown tests fiscal discipline, affects GDP, public-sector wages and consumer confidence – core topics for UPSC, State PCS and banking exams. Knowing the trigger (funding gap) and its macro-economic fallout is essential.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/federal-government-shutdown-2026-enters-day-3-agencies-shutter-amid-funding-deal-delay-11770033169417.html>

Tax Refund Nightmare! Partial Shutdown Could Stall Millions of Refunds

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The IRS opened tax filing for the 2025–2026 season on Jan. 26 amid concerns over refund statuses due to a partial government shutdown. Average refunds could reportedly rise to \$4,200, but delays may occur if the IRS scales back services during the shutdown.

Detailed analysis:

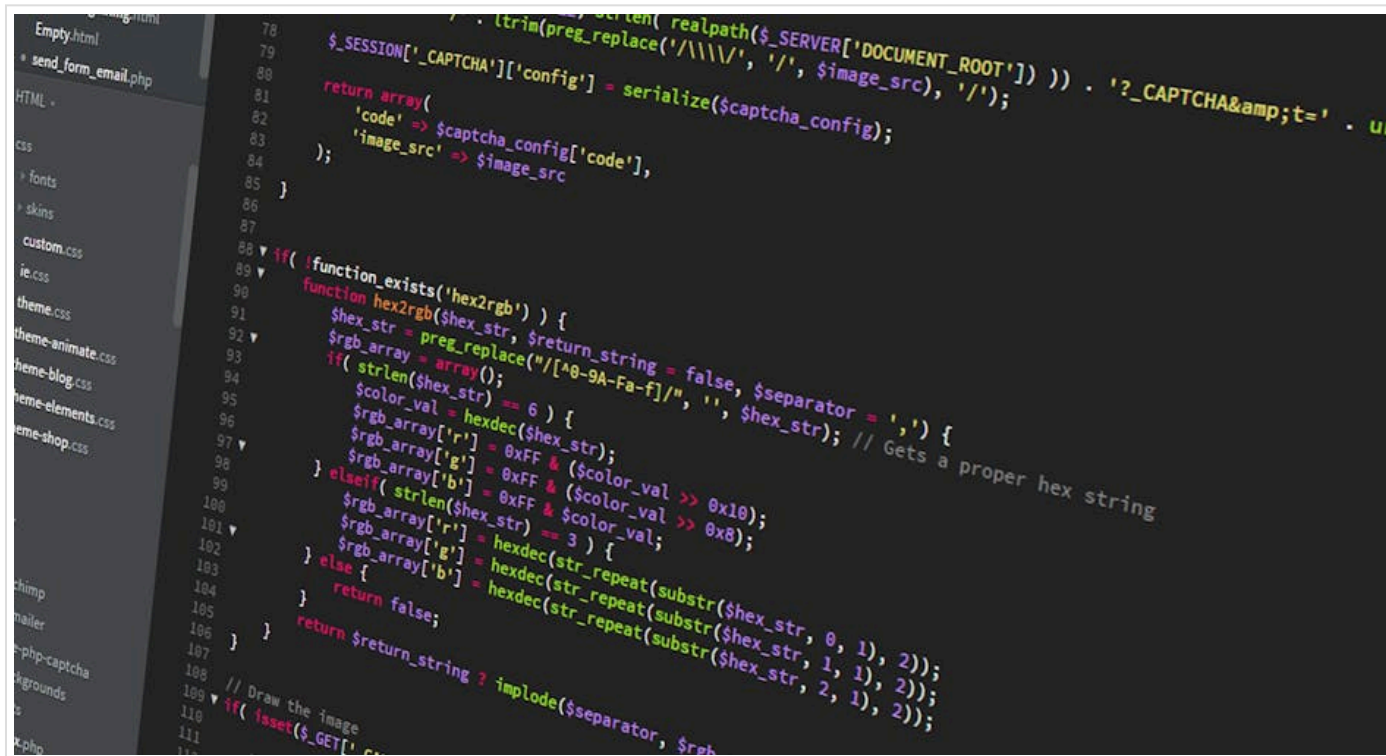
Understanding how a shutdown disrupts tax administration helps answer questions on public finance, revenue collection and citizen services—key for civil-service and banking exams.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/irs-refund-will-a-partial-government-shutdown-delay-refund-to-taxpayers-heres-what-we-know-11770035939464.html>

Image 1 (Real):



Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Centre will finalise rules under the Industrial Relations Code by February-end. The court noted that previous labour laws would remain in effect until new tribunals are established, alleviating concerns over legal vacuums and operational issues in industrial tribunals.

Detailed analysis:

Labour law reforms are a staple of UPSC and state-level exams. Knowing the timeline, scope and transitional provisions of the new code is vital for answering questions on industrial relations and employment policy.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/new-labour-code-rules-to-be-finalised-by-february-end-centre-informs-delhi-high-court-11770028160194.html>

Air India Halts 787-8 Flight Over Dangerous Fuel Switch Glitch!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Air India grounded one of its Boeing 787-8 aircraft after a pilot reported a possible defect with the fuel control switch. The company informed the DGCA of the matter and assured passengers that its primary focus is on people's safety.

Detailed analysis:

Aviation safety incidents affect airline valuations, insurance costs and regulatory scrutiny. Exam-takers should link such events to corporate governance, DGCA oversight and risk-management frameworks.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/air-india-grounds-flight-after-pilot-reports-possible-defect-with-fuel-control-switch-of-boeing-787-8-aircraft-11770038120082.html>

Trump Dreams of Building Washington's 'Greatest' Arch After Admiring India Gate!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

US President Donald Trump has praised India Gate while renewing his push to build what he calls the world's "greatest" triumphal arch in Washington, DC. The proposed monument is expected to be Trump's broader plan to reshape the US capital ahead of America's 250th anniversary.

Detailed analysis:

The article highlights US-India diplomatic signaling and potential cultural-infrastructure projects, useful for questions on foreign policy, soft power and bilateral trade implications.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/trump-praises-india-gate-says-washington-will-get-greatest-triumphal-arch-11770045168771.html>

Nuclear Talks on the Brink! Trump's Threats Could Spark US-Iran Negotiations!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Diplomatic efforts to restart Iran–US nuclear talks have intensified amid warnings of possible military action from President Donald Trump. Iranian officials say sanctions relief is a key priority, even as Tasnim reports that negotiations are still in an early stage with no confirmed timeline.

Detailed analysis:

Renewed nuclear talks can move oil markets, affect geopolitical risk premiums and influence Indian energy security – topics frequently examined in economics and international relations sections of competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/world/iranus-nuclear-talks-may-begin-soon-amid-trump-s-military-threats-report-11770040145860.html>

— SPORTS —

Indian Skier's Olympic Dream Hung in the Balance as IOC Says 'No'!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Indian skier Stanzin Lundup's Olympic participation is uncertain due to a court challenge, but the IOC confirmed he can still compete in Italy.

Detailed analysis:

Key for UPSC/IAS prelims – showcases the interplay of sports administration, legal challenges and international bodies, highlighting India's emerging presence in winter sports.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/others/winter-olympics-ioc-rejects-manjeet-s-entry-lundup-awaits-ministry-s-okay-101770045035378.html>

History Made! Devika Smashes All Competition to Win Thailand Masters

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The 20-year-old did not drop a single game through the tournament, producing a series of assured performances against a strong international field

Detailed analysis:

Important for sports & general studies – marks a milestone for Indian badminton, useful for questions on India's performance in Asian sports events.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/badminton/thailand-masters-devika-first-indian-shuttler-to-clinch-a-title-in-2026-101769969049908.html>

Alcaraz's Genius Playbook Crushes Djokovic – A Tactical Masterclass!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Carlos Alcaraz beat Novak Djokovic 2-6, 6-2, 6-3, 7-5 to lift the Norman Brookes Challenge Cup for the first time in his career

Detailed analysis:

Highlights strategic shifts in modern tennis; useful for sports strategy questions and for understanding India's interest in global tennis trends.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/tennis/turning-defence-into-dominance-carlos-alcarazs-tactical-masterstroke-that-toppled-novak-djokovic-in-melbourne-101770000706973.html>

Mbappé Saves the Day with a Buzzer-Beater Penalty!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Mbappé's last-gasp penalty lifts Real Madrid to 2-1 win over Rayo Vallecano in Spanish league

Detailed analysis:

Illustrates clutch performance under pressure – relevant for discussions on sports psychology and India's growing football fan base.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/mbapps-last-gasp-penalty-lifts-real-madrid-to-2-1-win-over-rayo-vallecano-in-spanish-league-101769975905068.html>

Tottenham's Late Surge Stuns City, Sends Arsenal Racing Ahead!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Tottenham roars back to draw with Man City and do Arsenal a favor in Premier League title race

Detailed analysis:

Premier League updates are high-interest for Indian audiences; useful for current affairs sections on international sports.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/tottenham-roars-back-to-draw-with-man-city-and-do-arsenal-a-favor-in-premier-league-title-race-101769975286642.html>

Snowstorm Halts NASCAR – Racing Meets Winter Chaos!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

NASCAR's Clash postponed to Wednesday due to historic snowfall in North Carolina

Detailed analysis:

Rare weather-induced disruption in a major US motorsport – good for general knowledge on how external factors affect sporting events.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/us-sports/nascars-clash-postponed-to-wednesday-due-to-historic-snowfall-in-north-carolina-101769976143047.html>

ISRO's Rocket Woes: PSLV Failures Spark Urgent June Relaunch!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The PSLV is ISRO's most successful satellite launch vehicle, and since 1993, has had an over 90% success rate, placing nearly 350 satellites into their intended orbits

Detailed analysis:

Highlights recent setbacks in India's premier launch vehicle, underscoring the need to understand launch mechanics and contingency planning—key topics for defence and technology sections of competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/investigation-into-pslv-failures-ongoing-next-launch-date-in-june-minister/article70583617.ece>

Scandal Alert: Indian Scientist's Tainted Ties to Jeffrey Epstein!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

If the global funding system is inherently rigged, is it ethical to demand that those at a disadvantage adhere to the most rigid moral gatekeeping?

Detailed analysis:

Raises ethical dilemmas in scientific research funding, a pertinent discussion for UPSC ethics and integrity modules and for understanding international research collaborations.

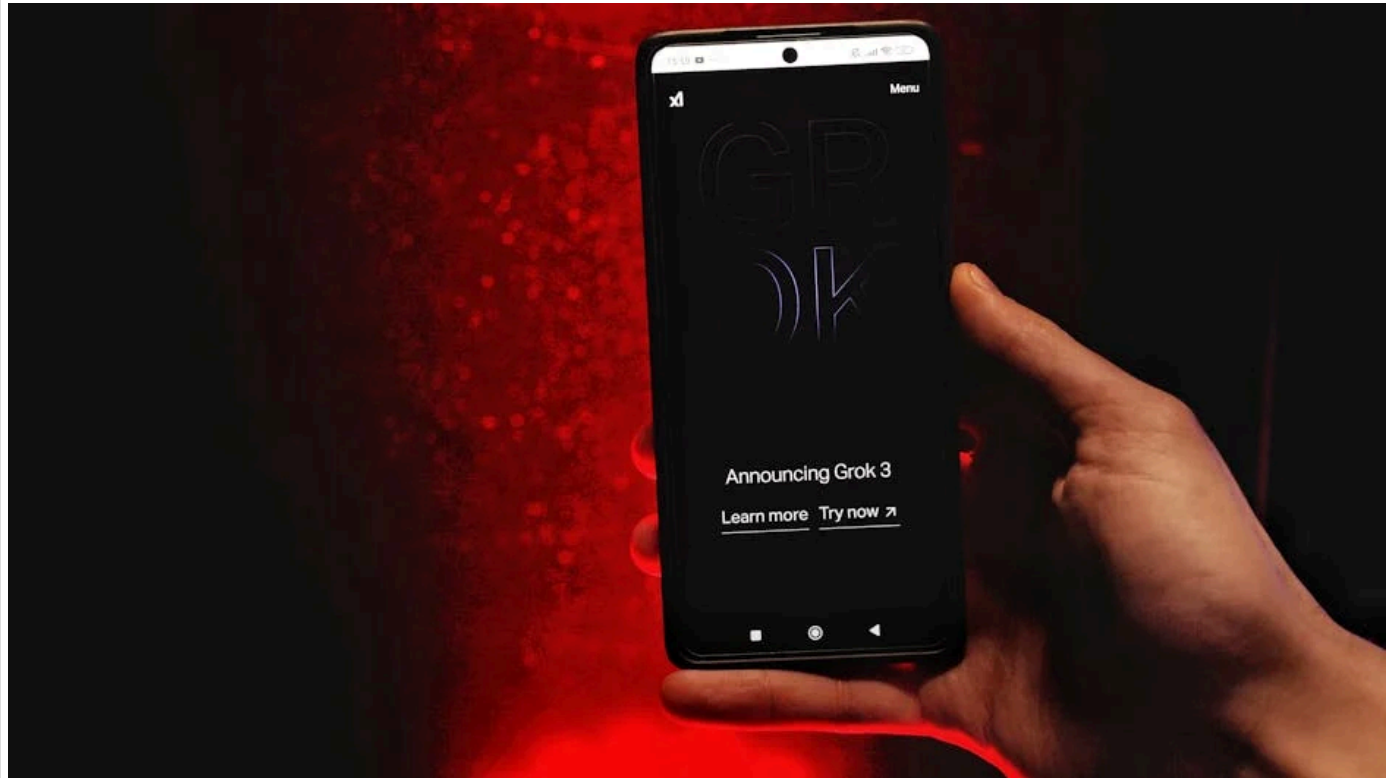
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/is-it-okay-for-an-indian-scientist-to-have-taken-jeffrey-epsteins-money/article70582561.ece>

Chatbot Showdown: Indonesia Reopens Elon Musk's Grok Amid Regional Ban!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Malaysia and the Philippines followed Indonesia in temporarily blocking access to the tool, which is integrated into X

Detailed analysis:

Illustrates regulatory challenges of AI tools across borders, useful for technology policy sections and for understanding AI governance in exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/technology/indonesia-says-it-will-restore-access-to-elon-musks-grok-chatbot/article70581453.ece>

Tiny Teeth Under Siege: 50% of Indian Toddlers Face Early Decay!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The idea that milk teeth do not need care is both common and incorrect, say experts. Studies show that nearly 50% of children in India develop dental decay at an early age, affecting oral health as well as eating habits, speech and school attendance.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights a major public-health concern for children; relevant for UPSC health-policy questions and preventive-care modules in medical services exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/why-an-increasing-number-of-toddlers-are-getting-cavities/article70556010.ece>

Silent Thyroid Threat: Detect & Prevent Before It Strikes Millions!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The swelling of the thyroid gland is a very common occurrence, and a significant percentage of the population will have a thyroid nodule, which may or may not get detected during one's lifetime.

Detailed analysis:

Provides essential data on prevalence and early-detection strategies, useful for questions on non-communicable diseases and health-system screening programmes.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/thyroid-disorders-prevention-and-early-detection/article70581936.ece>

Budget 2026 Fallout: Citizens Still Paying Sky-High Medical Bills!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

While exempting 17 cancer medicines from basic customs duty was welcome, there is little evidence to suggest that companies passed on the benefit to the customers in earlier instances.

Detailed analysis:

Critical for understanding fiscal allocations, price-control measures, and their impact on healthcare affordability – key topics for economics and public-policy sections of exams.

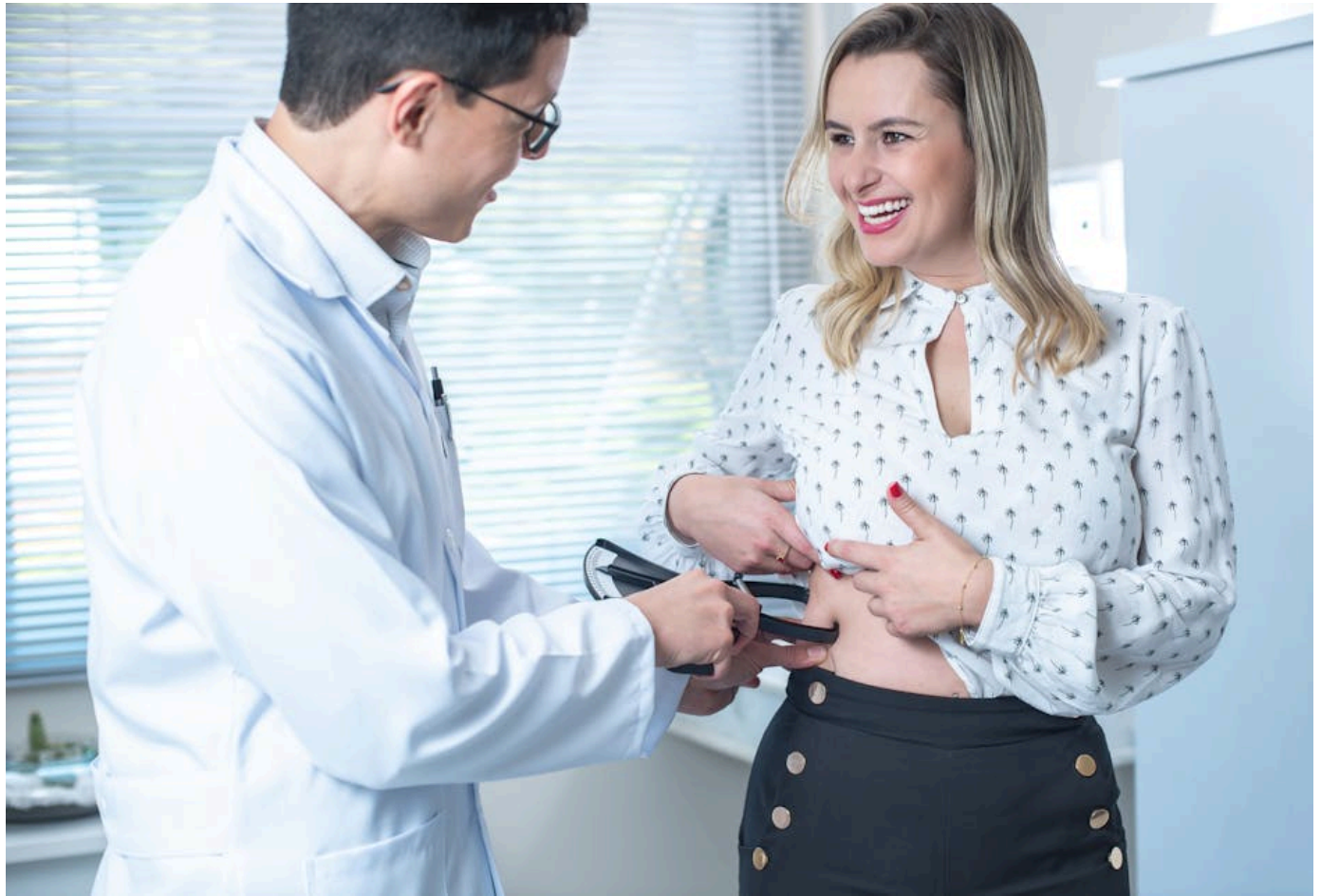
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/business/budget/union-budget-2026-does-little-to-reduce-out-of-pocket-expenses-medical-inflation-experts/article70578874.ece>

Cancer Drug Tax Break: ₹0 Duty on 17 Lifesaving Medicines!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Overall health spending saw only modest growth with the Health Ministry being allocated ₹1.05 lakh crore for FY 2026-27, just over six percent higher than the previous year and roughly nine percent more than the revised estimates.

Detailed analysis:

Shows targeted fiscal measures for oncology and rare diseases, illustrating policy priorities and budgetary constraints – valuable for questions on health financing and drug regulation.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/business/budget/budget-2026-cancer-drugs-custom-duties/article70577841.ece>

— EDUCATION —

Don't Miss! JEE Main Session 2 Opens – Register Now!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

JEE Main Session 2 Exam 2026 registration has started. The direct link to apply is given here.

Detailed analysis:

Crucial for engineering aspirants aiming for NITs and IITs. Register immediately as seats fill fast; keep your documents ready and note the last date to avoid missing the window.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/competitive-exams/jee-main-session-2-exam-2026-registration-begins-at-jeemain-nta-nic-in-direct-link-here-101770027595998.html>

Education Overhaul! New Varsity Townships & Girls' Hostels Unveiled in Budget 2026

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Budget 2026 was presented on February 1 by Finance Minister. Check the key announcements made for education sector this year.

Detailed analysis:

Key for policy-makers and students: increased infrastructure, gender-friendly hostels, and a new NIMHANS campus. Expect more research opportunities and improved access in tier-2/3 regions.

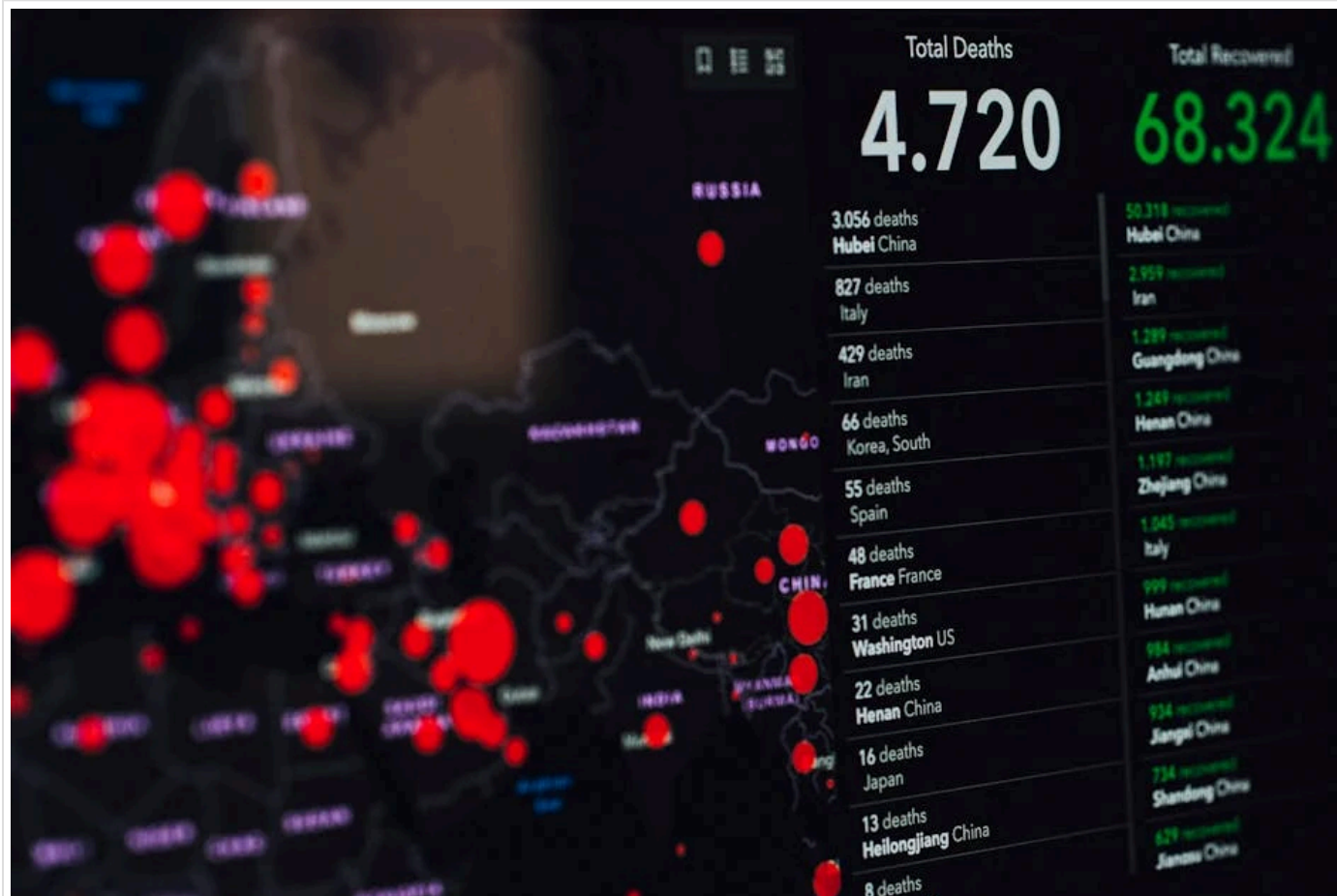
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/news/budget-2026-announcements-five-varsity-townships-girls-hostels-in-all-districts-nimhans-campus-for-north-india-101770022171974.html>

Massive ₹16,000 Cr Injection! KVS & NVS Set for a Grand Upgrade

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Union Budget 2026 released. KVS and NVS has received more than ₹16000 crore allocation this year. Check last 5 years allocation complete table here.

Detailed analysis:

Significant for school-teachers and administrators: higher salaries, better facilities, and digital upgrades. Candidates should watch for new recruitment drives in central schools.

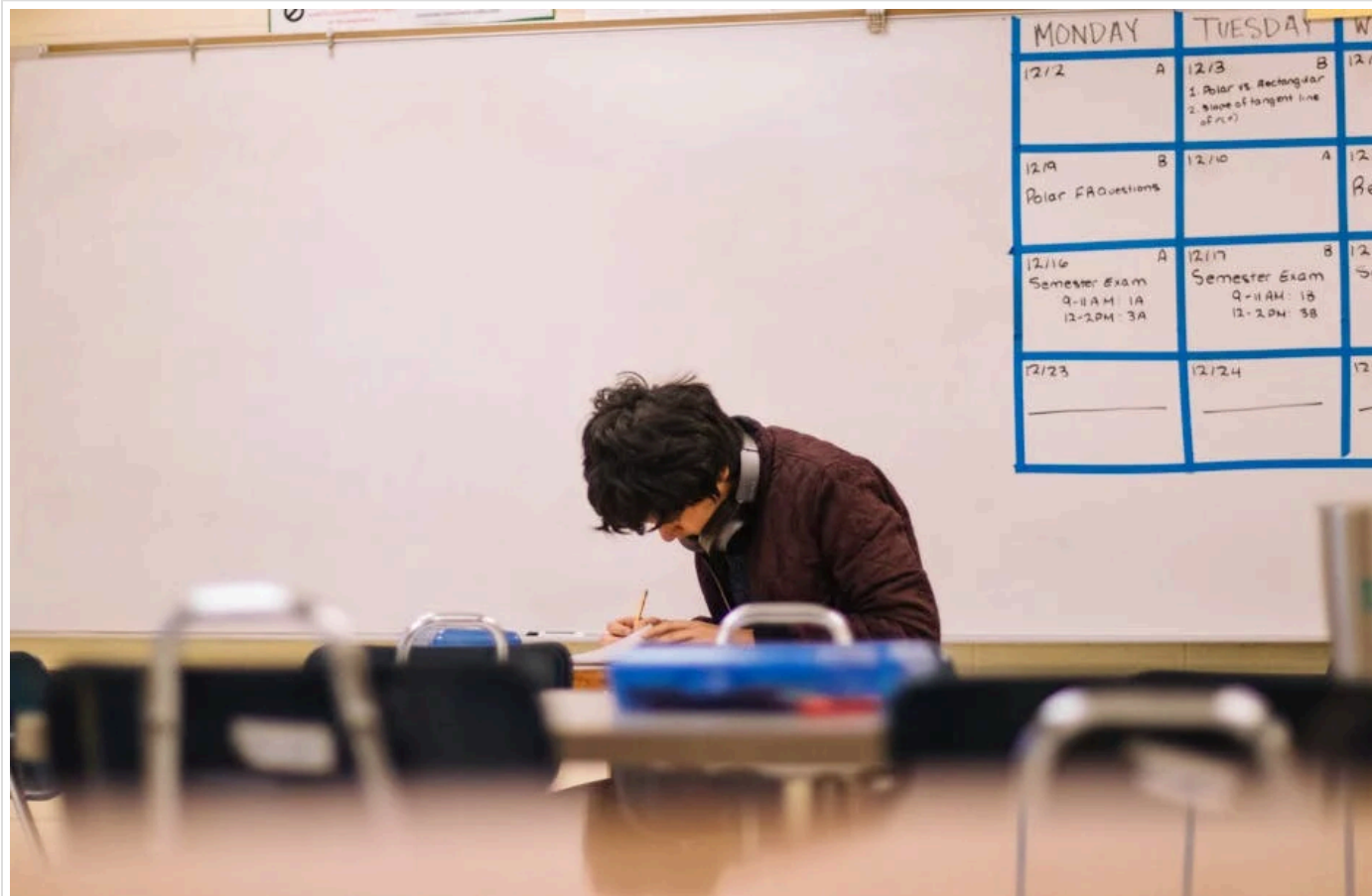
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/news/union-budget-2026-kvs-nvs-get-major-funding-boost-allocation-crosses-16-000-crore-101770006004969.html>

Gear Up! CTET Feb 2026 Dates Announced – Save the Calendar

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Detailed analysis:

Essential for aspiring teachers. Knowing the exact dates and paper-wise timing helps in targeted preparation and time-management strategies.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/cbse-ctet-february-2026-exam-dates-revised-check-detailed-paper-wise-timetable-admit-cards-10509571/>

Unlock a Summer at IIT Madras! Apply for the 2026 Fellowship Now

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Detailed analysis:

A prestigious opportunity for undergraduates and graduates to work on research projects with a stipend. Strong CV and clear research interests boost selection chances.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/iit-madras-application-summer-fellowship-programme-2026-eligibility-stipend-10508775/>

Skill Boost! Budget 2026 Supercharges ITI Funding Four-Fold

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Detailed analysis:

Vast increase in funding will modernize ITIs, introduce new courses, and improve placement prospects. Aspirants should monitor upcoming skill-training admissions and scholarships.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/education-budget-2026-skill-ministry-allocation-fourfold-upgrading-iti-pm-setu-major-focus-10508855/>

AI Gold Rush! 100% Tax Holiday Turns India into a Data-Centre Powerhouse

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Raamdeo Agrawal hails the government's 100% tax holiday for data centres until 2047 as a "transformational" policy. This move is expected to significantly boost India's participation in the global AI infrastructure race, leveraging cost advantages.

Detailed analysis:

The tax holiday removes a major cost barrier, attracting foreign and domestic investors to set up large-scale data farms. For UPSC and banking exams, note the policy's alignment with the Digital India agenda, its impact on capital formation, and potential boost to exports of AI services.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/expert-view/budgets-ai-infra-push-could-reshape-indias-growth-story-raamdeo-agrawal/articleshow/127857339.cms>

Liquidity Crunch Alert! Even a Tight Budget Can't Dodge Cash-Flow Storms

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India's Union Budget prioritizes continuity amid global uncertainty, with fiscal discipline largely achieved. While borrowing targets raise concerns, the focus shifts to proactive liquidity management to ensure fiscal discipline translates into lower borrowing costs and supports economic growth.

Detailed analysis:

Exam takers should focus on the distinction between fiscal deficit management and liquidity risk. The article underscores the need for effective cash-flow planning, which may be queried in GS Paper II (Economics) and in banking interviews.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/expert-view/budget-predictability-fiscal-discipline-positive-but-liquidity-remains-key-challenge-neelkanth-mishra/articleshow/127856066.cms>

Debt-Fuelled Growth: Capital Spending Gets a Power-Boost from Borrowings

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Government borrowing is increasingly financing capital expenditure, boosting economic growth potential as effective capital spending surpasses the fiscal deficit. Conservative tax revenue growth, alongside non-tax receipts and asset sales, provides a cushion. While revenue spending is managed, a slight increase in the budget size is observed, with a focus on easing the debt burden towards targets.

Detailed analysis:

For exam preparation, note the shift from revenue-centric to capex-centric fiscal strategy, the role of asset sales, and the impact on the debt-to-GDP ratio—common topics in the Economy section of the UPSC syllabus.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/policy/borrowing-to-build-govt-bets-on-capex-as-fiscal-deficit-stays-on-track/articleshow/127846842.cms>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India's Union Budget 2026-27 introduces a comprehensive customs overhaul, featuring duty relief for manufacturing and exports, and a single digital window for faster clearances. Measures aim to boost competitiveness in sectors like textiles and footwear, while rationalizing duties on strategic imports to enhance market access with the US.

Detailed analysis:

Important for understanding trade facilitation measures. Candidates should link this to the Make in India drive, export promotion, and the impact on balance of payments.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/foreign-trade/india-budget-customs-overhaul-to-cut-costs-boost-manufacturing/articleshow/127846481.cms>

Weather Warriors: ₹1,342 Cr Boost to Mission Mausam Super-charges Forecasts

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India is significantly boosting its weather forecasting. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has allocated Rs 1,342 crore for Mission Mausam. This ambitious initiative will use advanced technologies and computing to improve weather monitoring and prediction. The Ministry of Earth Sciences receives a total of Rs 3,789.23 crore. The Deep Ocean Mission also receives funding for exploration and technology development.

Detailed analysis:

Relevance for GS Paper II (Environment) and for general awareness: enhanced meteorological capabilities aid disaster management, agriculture planning, and maritime safety—key for policy-making questions.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/policy/mission-mausam-gets-rs-1342-crore-in-union-budget/articleshow/127844323.cms>

— ENVIRONMENT —

Himachal's Green Leap: 31% Forest Cover Target Set for 2030!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu directs the Forest department to prepare a comprehensive roadmap through sustainable planning to increase the State's forest cover, which is currently 29.5%.

Detailed analysis:

The target aligns with India's National Forest Policy and the UN's Sustainable Development Goal 15. Aspirants should note the policy shift, the role of state-level forest management, and the implications for climate-change mitigation and livelihood generation in the Himalayas.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/himachal-pradesh-govt-wants-to-increase-forest-cover-to-31-from-295-at-present/article70582790.ece>

Test Your Wetland Wisdom: World Wetlands Day Quiz Unveiled!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A quiz to mark the World Wetlands Day observed on February 2.

Detailed analysis:

World Wetlands Day highlights the ecological importance of wetlands for biodiversity, flood control, and carbon sequestration. The quiz can serve as a quick revision tool for exam topics such as Ramsar Convention, wetland ecosystem services, and related environmental policies.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/daily-quiz-on-world-wetlands-day/article70581645.ece>
